

eras from Frontech and Vivitar simply lacked feel—they were too light and lived up to their intended 'toyiness'.

Coming to menu navigation, some cameras offer easy icon-based menu navigation, while others have a linear navigation system controlled by one button. Samsung Digimax 210 had the best menu navigation of them all, with a superb tactile four-way button. All cameras, except for the Vivitar Vivicam 20, came with a memory upgrade slot, supporting an SD card, a Smart media, or an xD-picture card. Frontech was generous to offer 64 MB of internal memory with its Wonder CAM—a memory that not even higher-end cameras offer—followed by the Olympus C150 with 32 MB. All the rest of the cameras had a mere 8 MB to 16 MB internal memories. The Vivitar ViViCam 20 had 8 MB of internal memory, which is enough, considering its low 640 x

480 resolution. The file sizes are small (about 780 KB), which means it can hold about 15 images—a decent enough capacity for a toycom.



The Creative PC-Cam 850 has a high resolution of 2048 x 1536

Except for the Vivicam 20 and Wondercam, all the other cameras sported neat LCD screens. This comes in handy when previewing a frame in real time, before clicking the image. It also lets you preview the pictures you take, so that you can decide whether you need to do a retake.

On the power front, most cameras run on AA batteries—the Logitech Clicksmart 510 was the only camera that required four AAA batteries. Most cameras either use two AA batteries, or come with built-in chargeable batteries—such as the BenQ DC3410. This can be both, good or bad, depending on the scenario—good because you don't need to keep replacing bat-



CATEGORY		TOYCAMS					
CAMERA FEATURES	Model	Beng DC3410	Beng DC2300	Creative PC-Cam 850	Frontech Wonder CAM	Frontech Regal Cam	Logitech ClickSmart 510
	Max. Image resolution	2048 x 1536	2048 x 1536	2048 x 1536	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 960
	Digital Zoom	4x	4x	4x	NA	2x	X
	Autofocus	NA	✓	focus free	NA	X	X
	Macro focus range (cm)	30 to 40	18 to 25	35	NA	20 to 25	40 to 91
	White balance settings	Auto, 4 modes	Auto, 4 modes	Auto, 3 modes	NA	Auto, 3 modes	na
	Red-eye reduction	✓	✓	X	NA	✓	X
PHYSICAL FEATURES	Compressed image format	JPEG	JPEG	JPEG	JPEG	JPEG	BMP
	Dimensions (l x w x d) cms	98 x 58 x 27	94 x 66x 40	NA	NA	9.3 x 5.6 x 3.8	NA
	Weight (grams)	135	140	0	100	120	NA
	Memory types supported	SD card	SD card	SD card	SmartMedia	SD Card	SmartMedia
	Memory included (MB)	16, internal	8, internal	16, internal	64	8, built-in	8, SmartMedia
	LCD Monitor	✓	✓	✓	X	✓	X
	Battery form factor	Built-in	AA	AA	AA	AA	AAA
PERFORMANCE	Image Test (Photoshop)	2.6	11.6	10.65	11.8	0.4	1.85
	Details Test (0-2 each)	4.25	6	1.75	2	3.25	0
	RGB Target Test	0	4.87	0	3.47	1.97	1.75
	Zoom Test	2.5	2.5	2	1	1	0
W & S	Period of warranty (Years)	1	1	1	1	1	1
	Number of authorised service centres	18	18	NA	8	8	25
	Number of cities where service centres are present	8	8	NA	8	8	8
OVERALL SCORE	Camera feature (30%)	13	13	13	13	13	13
	Physical feature (15%)	8	8	8	6	8	6
	Performance (50%)	9.35	24.96	14.4	18.26	6.621	3.6
	Ergonomics (5%)	3	3.2	3.5	1	2	2.9
	Value for money	8.14	11	8.8	12.76	7.92	4.84
	Grade	C+	B-	C+	B	C+	C
CONTACT	Contact	BenQ India Pvt Ltd	BenQ India Pvt Ltd	Creative Labs Asia	Jupiter International Ltd	Jupiter International Ltd	Logitech Far East Ltd
	Phone	022-25705231	022-25705231	9820357713	022-22001211	022-22001211	022-24905149
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	Web site	www.benq.co.in	www.benq.co.in	www.Creative.com	www.jil-jupiter.com	www.jil-jupiter.com	www.logitech.com
CONTACT	Price	9,899	9,799	9,599	6,500	8,200	11,250

* Not awarded the value for money since is too poor for us to recommend buying it